GG-P-181c
August 14, 1963

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GG-P-00181b (GSA-FSS)
January 9, 1963 and
Fed. Spec. GG-P-181a
April 9, 1941

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PENHOLDERS (WRITING)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 **Scope.** This specification covers penholders for general office use.

1.2 **Classification.**

1.2.1 *Types.* Penholders covered by this specification shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I.—Cork grip, metal insert.
Type II.—Wood grip, imbedded metal end, with metal ferrule.
Type III.—Wood grip, imbedded metal end, without metal ferrule.
Type IV.—Wood grip, protruding metal center.

1.2.2 *Colors.* Type I penholders shall be furnished in black or red, as specified (see 6.1). Types II, III, and IV shall be furnished in black.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitations for bid, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:
PPP-B-566—Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665—Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676—Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standards:
Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:
MIL-P-116—Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:
MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

FSC 7510

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Material used shall be of the best quality and as specified hereinafter.

3.2 Component parts.

3.2.1 *Staff.* The penholder staff shall be round and symmetrically tapered and shall be provided with an efficient pen-point holding device.

3.2.2 *Pen-point holding device.* The pen-point holding device shall be made of corrosion-resisting metal, or metal having a corrosion-resisting metal plating, or be of a durable composition. The holding device shall hold pen points securely in position.

3.2.3 *Grip.* Cork grips shall not be smaller in diameter than the adjacent part of the staff and shall be neatly secured.

3.3 Design.

3.3.1 *Type I, cork grip, metal insert.* The penholder shall be not less than 6-3/4 inches long. Cork grips shall be not less than 7/16 inch in diameter near the grip end and shall taper symmetrically with the adjacent staff. The grip shall be of the metal-insert center type (flush end tip) in not less than two segments. The grip shall be not less than 1-3/16 inches long. The metal ferrule shall not separate from the penholder proper when a force of 15 pounds is applied as specified in 4.4.1.

3.3.2 *Type II, wood grip, imbedded metal end, with metal ferrule.* The penholder shall be not less than 6 inches long. The tapering wood staff shall be of one continuous piece approximately 3/8 inch in diameter at the grip end. The grip shall be provided with an imbedded metal end for insertion of pen and shall be reinforced by a ferrule made of corrosion-resisting metal not less than 5/32 inch high to prevent splitting of grip. The metal ferrule shall not separate from the penholder proper when a force of 15 pounds is applied as in 4.4.1.

3.3.3 *Type III, wood grip, imbedded metal end, without metal ferrule.* The penholder shall be not less than 6 inches long. The tapering all-wood staff shall be of one continuous piece of approximately 3/8 inch in diameter at the grip end. The grip shall be provided with an imbedded metal end for insertion of pen. The wood of the staff shall not split when tested as specified in 4.4.2.

3.3.4 *Type IV, wood grip, protruding metal center.* The penholder shall be not less than 6-3/4 inches in overall length. The tapering all-wood staff shall be of one continuous piece approximately 3/8 inch in diameter at the grip end. The grip shall be provided with a protruding or projecting metal penholding device securely fastened in a wooden holder by means of either a pricked-in metal ring or an outside metal ferrule fitted on the wood staff with a rivet or pin. The rivet or pin shall be properly rounded or smoothed to prevent harm to fingers. The wood of the staff shall not split when tested as specified in 4.4.2.

3.4 Finish. Unless otherwise specified, the staff shall be finished with a nonflaking and noncracking black lacquer or enamel.

3.5 Workmanship. All penholders shall be smoothly and neatly finished in a workmanlike manner and shall have a comfortable grip.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Supplier's responsibility. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspec-

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

tion requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 *Size of lot.* All penholders presented for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for acceptance inspection.

4.2.2 *Sampling for visual and dimensional examination.* Not more than three penholders shall be taken, at random, from each carton or box containing 1 dozen penholders, or multiples thereof. The sample unit shall be one penholder. The sample size shall be in accordance with Inspection Level I of MIL-STD-105, with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 2.5 percent defective.

4.2.3 *Sampling for tests.* Random samples contained in each carton or box shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level L-3, with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one penholder.

4.2.4 *Sampling for examination of preparation for delivery.* Sample shipping containers of packaged and packed penholders shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level L-5, with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one shipping container.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 *Visual and dimensional examination.* Sample penholders, selected in accordance with 4.2.2, shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. Any penholder having one or more defects shall be considered a defective penholder. If the number of defective penholders exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE I.—*Classification of defects (major)*

Visual examination	Defects
Penholder staff not round and not symmetrically tapered; not provided with an efficient pen-point holding device (does not hold pen-points securely in position)	X
Cork grips smaller in diameter than the adjacent part of the staff; not neatly secured	X
Dimensions not as specified	X
Rivet or pin not properly rounded or smoothed to prevent harm to the fingers (see 3.3.4)	X
Penholders not finished as specified	X
Workmanship not as specified	X

4.3.2 *Examination of preparation for delivery.* Sample shipping containers, selected in accordance with 4.2.4, shall be examined for compliance with packaging, packing, and marking requirements in section 5 of this specification.

4.4 Tests. Samples, selected in accordance with 4.2.3, shall be subjected to the following tests. Any penholder failing this test shall be considered a defective penholder. If the number of defective penholders exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4.1 *Types I and II* sample penholders shall be tested as follows: The penholder shall be placed on two blocks so that the penholder cannot roll. The blocks may be grooved if necessary. The blocks shall be located on a platform scale and the penholder placed so that the dividing line between the grip and the penholder proper is about 3/4 inch away from each block. Apply a force of 15 pounds at this dividing line by pressing an edge of a small steel block at this point.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

If the penholder withstands this test successfully, it shall then be subjected to a pull of 15 pounds which shall be applied by holding the grip about 3/8 inch from the tip by a suitable arrangement for application of an even pulling force, while the penholder proper is attached to a scale (or other suitable recording device). In all cases the clamp shall be sufficiently tight to pull off both the grip and the ferrule at one time.

4.4.2 *Types III and IV* sample penholders shall be tested as follows: Insert a corrosion-resisting steel pen into the penholder under test. The pen may have any type of point but the body shall be of falcon design. Press the pen and penholder down vertically against the platform of a scale. The pen and penholder shall be held in the vertical position for 5 minutes against a load of 10 pounds. Any bending or distortion of the pen shall be disregarded.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement, the definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.)

5.1 **Packaging.** Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.* The penholders shall be packaged in boxes conforming to PPP-B-566, style II, type A or B, class a; PPP-B-665, style optional; or to PPP-B-676, type optional. Each box shall be waterproofed in accordance with MIL-P-116, method 1-C-2.

5.1.2 *Level B.* Twelve penholders shall be packaged in boxes specified in 5.1 except the boxes shall not be waterproofed.

5.1.3 *Level C.* The penholders shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers' commercial practice.

5.1.4 *Intermediate packaging.* Three units of 12 penholders shall be intermediate packaged in boxes conforming to PPP-B-566, style II, or to PPP-B-665, style optional, or to PPP-B-676, type optional. The boxes shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto. Alternatively three units of 12 penholders may be placed in paperboard sleeves. The sleeves shall provide a snug-fit to insure adequate protection during handling and shipment.

5.2 **Packing.** Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 *Level A.* The penholders shall be packed in boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class 2, V3c, style optional. Each box shall be waterproof sealed with tape and reinforced with bands of filament tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 *Level B.* The penholders, in quantities specified (see 6.1), shall be packed in boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, type I, class 1. Each box shall be sealed and closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.* The penholders shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 **Marking.**

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to special markings required by the contract or order the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military activities.* In addition to special markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein (see 3.5) and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Type (as applicable) of penholder required (1.2.1).
(*c*) Color of type I penholder (1.2.2).
(*d*) Inspection responsibility (for civil agencies only) if other than as specified herein; and administrative provisions for inspection records, when applicable (4.1).
(*e*) Level of packaging and packing required (5.1 and 5.2).
(*f*) Quantity required for level B packing (5.2.2).

6.2 Transportation description. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:
Penholders, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:
Penholders, not otherwise indexed.
Truckload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

6.3 Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.4 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.